# Over 2.5 goals: V4 report

Wed 28 Oct 2026 to Fri 30 Oct 2026 (english). All times UK.

## Executive summary

13 fixtures analysed: High 0, Medium 5, Weak 1, rejected 7. Selected fixtures with both attacks scoring 2+ in 3 of 5 or better: 3.

Selection engine: the validated model (V4 lock, unchanged since 19 Oct 2026). Out of sample it hit 69% in High (729 fixtures), 64% across all selected (2,518), 54% rejected (5,017). Those are band rates, not the chance of any one fixture. Scored 2+ and Let in 2+ counts are shown on every card as supporting evidence; both attacks at 3 of 5+ adds about three points inside the bands and is highlighted, not required.

## Selected fixtures ranked by model score (up to 20)

| # | Kick-off (UK) | Competition | Fixture | Home sc2+ / let2+ | Away sc2+ / let2+ | Both 3/5+ | BTTS | Confidence | Division | Main risk (Over 2.5 = Yes for every row) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Wed 28 Oct 19:30 | EFL Cup | Manchester City v Brighton | 3/5 · 3/5 | 4/5 · 1/5 | yes | NO (Med) | Medium | warm | Home side kept 2/5 clean sheets |
| 2 | Wed 28 Oct 19:45 | National League | Sutton Utd v Aldershot Town | 1/5 · 4/5 | 1/5 · 3/5 | | NO (Med) | Medium | warm | Sutton Utd let in 2+ in 4 of 5 but scored 2+ only 1 of 5: leaky, not scoring |
| 3 | Wed 28 Oct 19:45 | National League | Forest Green v Eastleigh | 2/5 · 3/5 | 1/5 · 4/5 | | YES (Med) | Medium | warm | Eastleigh let in 2+ in 4 of 5 but scored 2+ only 1 of 5: leaky, not scoring |
| 4 | Fri 30 Oct 19:45 | National League | AFC Fylde v AFC Hornchurch | 2/5 · 3/5 | 2/5 · 3/5 | | NO (Med) | Medium | warm | Home side failed to score in 2/5 |
| 5 | Wed 28 Oct 19:45 | National League | Carlisle v Harrogate Town | 4/5 · 1/5 | 3/5 · 0/5 | yes | NO (Med) | Medium | warm | Home side kept 2/5 clean sheets |
| 6 | Wed 28 Oct 19:45 | EFL Cup | Bournemouth v Aston Villa | 3/5 · 2/5 | 3/5 · 3/5 | yes | YES (Med) | Weak | warm | Home side kept 2/5 clean sheets |

# Grouped shortlist (date, competition, confidence, model score)

## Fri 30 Oct · National League

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Medium | AFC Fylde v AFC Hornchurch 19:45 | H scored 2+ 2/5 · H let in 2+ 3/5 · A scored 2+ 2/5 · A let in 2+ 3/5 | BTTS NO (Medium) |

## Wed 28 Oct · EFL Cup

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Medium | Manchester City v Brighton 19:30 | H scored 2+ 3/5 · H let in 2+ 3/5 · A scored 2+ 4/5 · A let in 2+ 1/5 · both 3/5+ | BTTS NO (Medium) |
| Weak | Bournemouth v Aston Villa 19:45 | H scored 2+ 3/5 · H let in 2+ 2/5 · A scored 2+ 3/5 · A let in 2+ 3/5 · both 3/5+ | BTTS YES (Medium) |

## Wed 28 Oct · National League

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Medium | Sutton Utd v Aldershot Town 19:45 | H scored 2+ 1/5 · H let in 2+ 4/5 · A scored 2+ 1/5 · A let in 2+ 3/5 | BTTS NO (Medium) |
| Medium | Forest Green v Eastleigh 19:45 | H scored 2+ 2/5 · H let in 2+ 3/5 · A scored 2+ 1/5 · A let in 2+ 4/5 | BTTS YES (Medium) |
| Medium | Carlisle v Harrogate Town 19:45 | H scored 2+ 4/5 · H let in 2+ 1/5 · A scored 2+ 3/5 · A let in 2+ 0/5 · both 3/5+ | BTTS NO (Medium) |

# Fixture cards

## National League

### AFC Fylde v AFC Hornchurch

National League · Fri 30 Oct 19:45 UK

**OVER 2.5 YES · confidence MEDIUM**

BTTS NO (Medium) · One side dominates

Division: warm, 111 of 174 games had 3+

**AFC FYLDE home**

oldest → newest

scores: 0-2, 1-3, 2-0, 0-4, 3-1

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **SCORED 2+** |  | **2/5** |
| **LET IN 2+** |  | **3/5** |
| Game had 3+ |  | 3/5 |
| Both scored |  | 2/5 |
| At home, 3+ |  | 3/5 |

**AFC HORNCHURCH away**

oldest → newest

scores: 2-1, 0-3, 2-0, 1-2, 1-2

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **SCORED 2+** |  | **2/5** |
| **LET IN 2+** |  | **3/5** |
| Game had 3+ |  | 4/5 |
| Both scored |  | 3/5 |
| Away, 3+ |  | 4/5 |

**HOME ATTACK → AWAY DEFENCE**

AFC Fylde scored 2+: 2/5

AFC Hornchurch let in 2+: 3/5

**Route: Some support**

AFC Fylde: clean sheets 1/5, failed to score 2/5, both scored 2/5

**AWAY ATTACK → HOME DEFENCE**

AFC Hornchurch scored 2+: 2/5

AFC Fylde let in 2+: 3/5

**Route: Some support**

AFC Hornchurch: clean sheets 1/5, failed to score 1/5, both scored 3/5

**Why:** AFC Fylde 3 of 5 games with 3+ and AFC Hornchurch 4 of 5; both scored in 2 of 5 (AFC Fylde) and 3 of 5 (AFC Hornchurch). Venue: AFC Fylde 3 of 5 home games with 3+, AFC Hornchurch 4 of 5 away.

**Risk:** Home side failed to score in 2/5

### Carlisle v Harrogate Town

National League · Wed 28 Oct 19:45 UK

**OVER 2.5 YES · confidence MEDIUM**

BTTS NO (Medium) · One side dominates

Division: warm, 111 of 174 games had 3+

**both attacks 3 of 5+**

**CARLISLE home**

oldest → newest

scores: 2-5, 2-0, 3-1, 0-0, 2-1

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **SCORED 2+** |  | **4/5** |
| **LET IN 2+** |  | **1/5** |
| Game had 3+ |  | 3/5 |
| Both scored |  | 3/5 |
| At home, 3+ |  | 3/5 |

**HARROGATE TOWN away**

oldest → newest

scores: 4-1, 1-0, 3-0, 1-0, 3-1

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **SCORED 2+** |  | **3/5** |
| **LET IN 2+** |  | **0/5** |
| Game had 3+ |  | 3/5 |
| Both scored |  | 2/5 |
| Away, 3+ |  | 2/5 |

**HOME ATTACK → AWAY DEFENCE**

Carlisle scored 2+: 4/5

Harrogate Town let in 2+: 0/5

**Route: Weak**

Carlisle: clean sheets 2/5, failed to score 1/5, both scored 3/5

**AWAY ATTACK → HOME DEFENCE**

Harrogate Town scored 2+: 3/5

Carlisle let in 2+: 1/5

**Route: Weak**

Harrogate Town: clean sheets 3/5, failed to score 0/5, both scored 2/5

**Why:** Carlisle 3 of 5 games with 3+ and Harrogate Town 3 of 5; both scored in 3 of 5 (Carlisle) and 2 of 5 (Harrogate Town). Venue: Carlisle 3 of 5 home games with 3+, Harrogate Town 2 of 5 away.

**Risk:** Home side kept 2/5 clean sheets

## Forest Green v Eastleigh

National League · Wed 28 Oct 19:45 UK

**OVER 2.5 YES · confidence MEDIUM**

BTTS YES (Medium) · Both teams contribute

Division: warm, 111 of 174 games had 3+

### FORREST GREEN home

oldest → newest

scores: 1-3, 3-3, 1-1, 2-4, 0-1

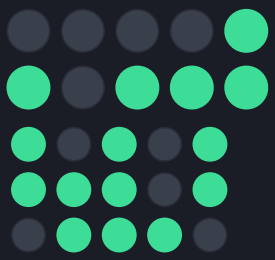


| | |
|---|---|
| **SCORED 2+** | **2/5** |
| **LET IN 2+** | **3/5** |
| Game had 3+ | 3/5 |
| Both scored | 4/5 |
| At home, 3+ | 4/5 |

### EASTLEIGH away

oldest → newest

scores: 1-4, 1-1, 1-3, 0-2, 4-2



| | |
|---|---|
| **SCORED 2+** | **1/5** |
| **LET IN 2+** | **4/5** |
| Game had 3+ | 3/5 |
| Both scored | 4/5 |
| Away, 3+ | 3/5 |

**HOME ATTACK → AWAY DEFENCE**

Forest Green scored 2+: 2/5

Eastleigh let in 2+: 4/5

**Route: Some support**

Forest Green: clean sheets 0/5, failed to score 1/5, both scored 4/5

**AWAY ATTACK → HOME DEFENCE**

Eastleigh scored 2+: 1/5

Forest Green let in 2+: 3/5

**Route: Weak**

Eastleigh: clean sheets 0/5, failed to score 1/5, both scored 4/5

**Why:** Forest Green 3 of 5 games with 3+ and Eastleigh 3 of 5; both scored in 4 of 5 (Forest Green) and 4 of 5 (Eastleigh). Venue: Forest Green 4 of 5 home games with 3+, Eastleigh 3 of 5 away.

**Risk:** Eastleigh let in 2+ in 4 of 5 but scored 2+ only 1 of 5: leaky, not scoring

## Sutton Utd v Aldershot Town

National League · Wed 28 Oct 19:45 UK

**OVER 2.5 YES · confidence MEDIUM**

BTTS NO (Medium) · One side dominates

Division: warm, 111 of 174 games had 3+

### SUTTON UTD home

oldest → newest

scores: 3-3, 0-2, 1-1, 0-2, 1-3



| | |
|---|---|
| **SCORED 2+** | **1/5** |
| **LET IN 2+** | **4/5** |
| Game had 3+ | 2/5 |
| Both scored | 3/5 |
| At home, 3+ | 2/5 |

### ALDERSHOT TOWN away

oldest → newest

scores: 5-1, 1-2, 1-3, 1-3, 0-1



| | |
|---|---|
| **SCORED 2+** | **1/5** |
| **LET IN 2+** | **3/5** |
| Game had 3+ | 4/5 |
| Both scored | 4/5 |
| Away, 3+ | 3/5 |

**HOME ATTACK → AWAY DEFENCE**

Sutton Utd scored 2+: 1/5

Aldershot Town let in 2+: 3/5

**Route: Weak**

Sutton Utd: clean sheets 0/5, failed to score 2/5, both scored 3/5

**AWAY ATTACK → HOME DEFENCE**

Aldershot Town scored 2+: 1/5

Sutton Utd let in 2+: 4/5

**Route: Weak**

Aldershot Town: clean sheets 0/5, failed to score 1/5, both scored 4/5

**Why:** Sutton Utd 2 of 5 games with 3+ and Aldershot Town 4 of 5; both scored in 3 of 5 (Sutton Utd) and 4 of 5 (Aldershot Town). Venue: Sutton Utd 2 of 5 home games with 3+, Aldershot Town 3 of 5 away.

**Risk:** Sutton Utd let in 2+ in 4 of 5 but scored 2+ only 1 of 5: leaky, not scoring

## Manchester City v Brighton

EFL Cup · Wed 28 Oct 19:30 UK

**OVER 2.5 YES · confidence MEDIUM**

BTTS NO (Medium) · One side dominates

Division: warm, 43 of 78 games had 3+

**both attacks 3 of 5+**

### MANCHESTER CITY home

oldest → newest

scores: 1-0, 5-3, 3-0, 3-2, 1-2

| | |
|---|---|
| **SCORED 2+** | **3/5** |
| **LET IN 2+** | **3/5** |
| Game had 3+ | 4/5 |
| Both scored | 3/5 |
| At home, 3+ | 3/4 |

### BRIGHTON away

oldest → newest

scores: 5-0, 3-0, 2-0, 5-0, 0-2

| | |
|---|---|
| **SCORED 2+** | **4/5** |
| **LET IN 2+** | **1/5** |
| Game had 3+ | 3/5 |
| Both scored | 0/5 |
| Away, 3+ | 2/4 |

**HOME ATTACK → AWAY DEFENCE**

Manchester City scored 2+: 3/5

Brighton let in 2+: 1/5

**Route: Weak**

Manchester City: clean sheets 2/5, failed to score 0/5, both scored 3/5

**AWAY ATTACK → HOME DEFENCE**

Brighton scored 2+: 4/5

Manchester City let in 2+: 3/5

**Route: Strong**

Brighton: clean sheets 4/5, failed to score 1/5, both scored 0/5

**Why:** Manchester City 4 of 5 games with 3+ and Brighton 3 of 5; both scored in 3 of 5 (Manchester City) and 0 of 5 (Brighton). Venue: Manchester City 3 of 4 home games with 3+, Brighton 2 of 4 away.

**Risk:** Home side kept 2/5 clean sheets

## Bournemouth v Aston Villa

EFL Cup · Wed 28 Oct 19:45 UK

**OVER 2.5 YES · confidence WEAK**

BTTS YES (Medium) · Both teams contribute

Division: warm, 43 of 78 games had 3+

**both attacks 3 of 5+**

### BOURNEMOUTH home

oldest → newest

scores: 2-2, 0-1, 1-5, 2-0, 3-0

| | |
|---|---|
| **SCORED 2+** | **3/5** |
| **LET IN 2+** | **2/5** |
| Game had 3+ | 3/5 |
| Both scored | 2/5 |
| At home, 3+ | 1/4 |

### ASTON VILLA away

oldest → newest

scores: 1-2, 3-2, 2-2, 1-0, 2-1

| | |
|---|---|
| **SCORED 2+** | **3/5** |
| **LET IN 2+** | **3/5** |
| Game had 3+ | 4/5 |
| Both scored | 4/5 |
| Away, 3+ | 2/4 |

**HOME ATTACK → AWAY DEFENCE**

Bournemouth scored 2+: 3/5

Aston Villa let in 2+: 3/5

**Route: Strong**

Bournemouth: clean sheets 2/5, failed to score 1/5, both scored 2/5

**AWAY ATTACK → HOME DEFENCE**

Aston Villa scored 2+: 3/5

Bournemouth let in 2+: 2/5

**Route: Some support**

Aston Villa: clean sheets 1/5, failed to score 0/5, both scored 4/5

**Why:** Bournemouth 3 of 5 games with 3+ and Aston Villa 4 of 5; both scored in 2 of 5 (Bournemouth) and 4 of 5 (Aston Villa). Venue: Bournemouth 1 of 4 home games with 3+, Aston Villa 2 of 4 away.

**Risk:** Home side kept 2/5 clean sheets

## Rejected fixtures, with the model's reason

| Kick-off (UK) | Competition | Fixture | H sc2+ | H let2+ | A sc2+ | A let2+ | Model | Reason |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Fri 30 Oct 20:00 | Championship | Sheffield Utd v Wrexham | 2/5 | 2/5 | 2/5 | 2/5 | rejected | model score below the selection line; attacks 2/5 and 2/5 |
| Fri 30 Oct 19:45 | League Two | Newport County v Chesterfield | 1/5 | 1/5 | 3/5 | 2/5 | rejected | model score below the selection line; attacks 1/5 and 3/5 |
| Wed 28 Oct 19:45 | National League South | Farnborough v Weston-super-Mare | 2/5 | 3/5 | 1/5 | 2/5 | rejected | model score below the selection line; attacks 2/5 and 1/5 |
| Thu 29 Oct 19:45 | EFL Cup | Everton v Newcastle | 1/5 | 3/5 | 2/5 | 2/5 | rejected | model score below the selection line; attacks 1/5 and 2/5 |
| Wed 28 Oct 19:45 | EFL Cup | Fulham v Crystal Palace | 0/5 | 1/5 | 2/5 | 3/5 | rejected | model score below the selection line; attacks 0/5 and 2/5 |
| Wed 28 Oct 19:45 | EFL Cup | Sunderland v Brentford | 1/5 | 4/5 | 3/5 | 3/5 | rejected | model score below the selection line; attacks 1/5 and 3/5 |
| Wed 28 Oct 20:00 | EFL Cup | Liverpool v Chelsea | 2/5 | 1/5 | 3/5 | 3/5 | rejected | model score below the selection line; attacks 2/5 and 3/5 |

## Data coverage and limitations

• Fixtures analysed: 13. Every count is taken from the stored final score of each match (fixture ID, teams, score); the five scorelines are printed on each card.

• Form sample: each side's last five completed league games this season, cup ties excluded; venue rows use the last five league games at that venue, sample size shown when fewer.

• Not covered by API Sports for 2026-27: Northern Premier, Isthmian and Southern League Division One. 'England V2' is not an API Sports competition and was not included.

• Scored first / conceded after leading: needs match event timelines, not pulled (one call per match, no history). Not shown. First-half goals: available from half-time scores, not yet on the card.

• Injuries and suspensions: the API returned lists for a minority of fixtures this week; nothing is inferred where it returned none. Squad rotation in cup ties is not assessed.

• Opposition strength: each side's opponents' scoring versus the division is held in the analysis file (oq columns) but is not part of the alignment score.

• Competitions in scope with no fixtures in the window: Premier League, League One, National League North, Northern Premier League, Isthmian Premier, Southern Premier Central, Southern Premier South, FA Cup, EFL Trophy, FA Trophy.

## Methodology (V4 lock)

• Selection: gradient-boosted model on each side's last-5 league counts (goals, 3+, 2+ scored, 2+ conceded, clean sheets, failed to score, BTTS), last-3 venue counts and the division's 3+ share. Trained on 2023-24 and 2024-25, validated on 2025-26; cut points from validation deciles. High = top decile; Medium = next two; Weak = bottom quarter of Medium; rejected below.

• Out of sample (Jan to Jun 2026 and Aug to Oct 2026, 7,535 fixtures): High 69% (729), Selected 64% (2,518), rejected 54% (5,017). Band rates, not per-fixture probabilities.

• Scored 2+ and Let in 2+ are shown for both sides as evidence. Both attacks 3 of 5+ is highlighted (Selected with it 66%, High 71%) but never required: High fixtures failing a 2-of-5 attacking rule hit 73% on 222 fixtures.

• BTTS: YES when the pattern is 'both teams contribute' (two scoring routes, each side scoring in 4 of 5 and conceding in 3 of 5); likelihood from a second validated model (High 61%, Medium 55%, Low 50%). A lean, not a pick.

• V2 and V3 alignment scores were tested (62 to 66% at comparable sizes) and are not used for selection. Full tables in over25_backtest_baseline.md.

• No averages anywhere. Nothing inferred for missing data. Every count comes from stored final scores; the five scorelines are printed on each card.